

The Civic Virtue Climb

Civics · teens–adult (citizenship-class ready) · 30 minutes · one screen, the free game, this page

For your homeschool table — a 30-minute lesson, zero prep. Open the free game on any screen and follow the five steps. Where a step says “the room/the group,” read it as your family; where it says “host,” that’s you.

1 · THE HOOK (3 min)

“If government vanished at midnight, what’s the first thing you’d miss by morning — and the first thing you wouldn’t?”

2 · PLAY TOGETHER (12 min)

Climb ten questions; the system, not a side — if partisan opinions flare, the host’s one rule: “we’re studying the machine today, not the drivers.”

Play together: the group votes before anyone clicks, and every explanation is read aloud — the explanation is the lesson.

3 · THE TALK (8 min)

1. Why three branches instead of one efficient one — what were the designers afraid of?
2. Which right would you defend for someone you completely disagree with?
3. What’s the smallest real civic act you could perform this month — not voting, smaller?

4 · SOLO CLIMB (5 min)

Five questions. (Naturalization-prep learners: this climb doubles as citizenship-test conditioning.)

5 · THE TAKEAWAY (2 min)

“The machine belongs to whoever understands it.”

Homework: Look up one local decision being made this month — council, school board, county — and read what’s actually being decided.

THE TEACHING CREED

You are not the expert; the game is. Your job is to vote last, read aloud well, and ask “why?” one more time than feels natural. Celebrate wrong answers loudly — in here, wrong is where the lesson lives.

GENO — the GSU tutor you can talk to, free, 24/7 in 32 languages — can explain any answer a second way.